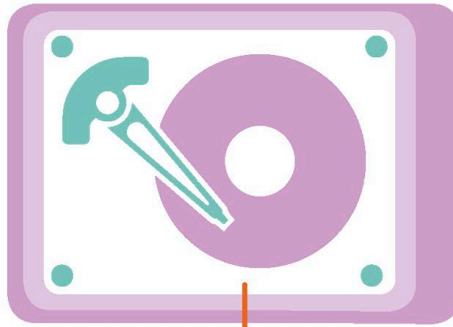


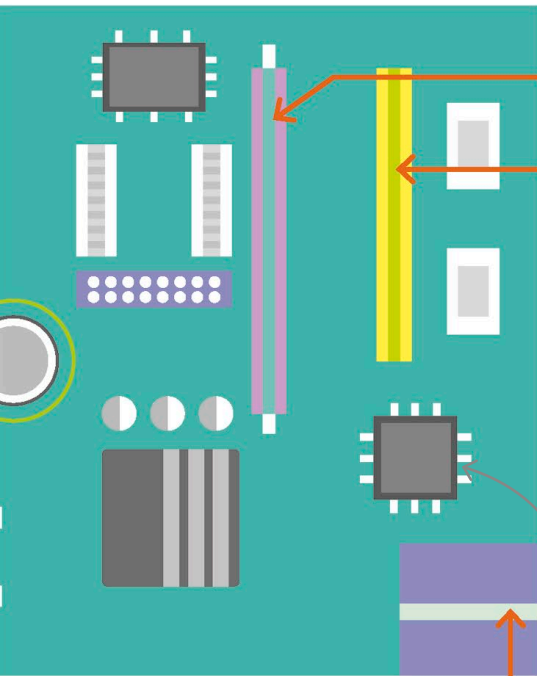
▽ **Motherboard**

The computer's main circuit board is called the motherboard. It allows the other components to communicate with each other. The motherboard is a thin plate that holds the CPU, memory, connectors for the hard drive and optical drive, expansion cards to control the video and audio, and connections to a computer's ports. It holds all the circuitry that ties the functions of the computer components together.

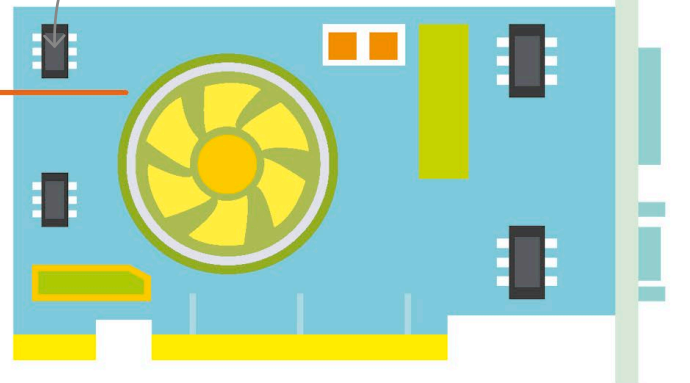


◁ **Hard drive**

A computer's software, documents, and other files are stored on its hard drive as binary code. It holds data, even if the computer is switched off or unplugged. The quicker the hard drive, the faster the computer can start up and load programs.



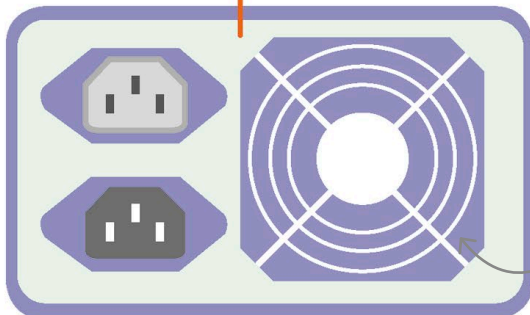
A computer system generally has between one and seven expansion slots.



Chips provide extra processing power for specific parts of the computer.

△ **Expansion slots**

These slots allow the user to add various types of expansion card, which help to boost or update the performance of a computer. Expansion cards can upgrade the sound or video, or enable the computer to connect to networks or Bluetooth.



◁ **Power unit**

This converts the power from the wall outlet to the type of power needed by the computer. Power is sent to the motherboard and other components through cables. The power unit also regulates overheating by controlling voltage, which may change automatically or manually depending on the power supply.

Power units usually have a fan that stops the computer's components from overheating.